

CDC Flexi 02 – 2026

VARC Section — 24 Questions

Question 1

The passage given below is followed by four summaries. Choose the option that best captures the essence of the passage.

Nicola Coughlan is sick of the subject of "body positivity", and thank God, because so am I. "The thing I say sometimes that pisses people off is I have no interest in body positivity," she said in a recent interview. Like Coughlan and no doubt many, many other women, I'm sick of talking about it, thinking about it, reading about it, all of it (I do recognise a certain irony in my writing about it, but hear me out). In the same interview, Coughlan recounted an encounter with a fan: "I remember this really drunk girl once talking to me in a bathroom being like, 'I loved [Bridgerton] because of your body' and started talking about my body, and I was like, 'I want to die. I hate this so much.'"

- 1) The author agrees with Nicola Coughlan's rejection of body positivity discourse, arguing that constant focus on women's bodies remains intrusive and exhausting.
- 2) The passage critiques celebrity culture in which actors are reduced to their physical appearance despite movements meant to promote body acceptance.
- 3) The author reflects on how public conversations about body positivity often make women uncomfortable by keeping attention fixed on their bodies.
- 4) Using Nicola Coughlan's remarks, the passage questions whether body positivity campaigns genuinely empower women or reinforce objectification.

Question 2

The given sentence is missing in the paragraph below. Decide where it best fits among the options 1, 2, 3, or 4 indicated in the paragraph.

Sentence: In 19th-century England, novelists crafted works that subtly but powerfully critiqued the social and economic limitations imposed on women.

Paragraph: ____1____. Every year, the world pauses to celebrate the social, economic, cultural and political achievements of women on International Women's Day (IWD). It is also a moment to reflect on the work still to be done. ____2____. Nowhere is that reflection more profound ~ or more enduring ~ than in literature. Across centuries and continents, women writers have challenged conventions, redefined storytelling, and insisted that women's lives, inner worlds, and ambitions belong at the centre of the intellectual and creative history of the human race. ____3____. For much of literary history, women were present in stories but absent from authorship. When they did write, they often did so under pseudonyms or within constrained genres. Yet even in restrictive eras, their voices found ways to resonate. ____4____. Austen's keen observations of marriage and money exposed the transactional realities facing women without fortune, while Brontë's passionate heroines demanded emotional and intellectual equality.

- 1) Option 2
- 2) Option 3
- 3) Option 1
- 4) Option 4

Question 3

The four sentences (labelled 1, 2, 3, and 4) given below, when properly sequenced, would yield a coherent paragraph. Decide on the proper sequencing of the order of the sentences and key in the sequence of the four numbers as your answer.

1. This month Anthropic and OpenAI each disclosed evidence that leading Chinese AI labs have illicitly used American models to train their own.
2. America's top artificial-intelligence labs have accused their Chinese rivals of being ruthless copycats.
3. "China is, in effect, stealing the weights of our best AI models," says Chris McGuire of the Council on Foreign Relations, an American think-tank.
4. The firms accuse Chinese researchers of aggressively "distilling" American chatbots—feeding them prompts in order to learn from and mimic their responses.

[Integer Type — Key in the correct sequence]

Directions for Questions 4 to 7: The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

The rapid developments in the cryptocurrency markets and the significant increase in cryptocurrencies in recent years have not come without environmental costs. Cryptocurrencies like Bitcoin operate without centralization, devoid of a single authority or entity tasked with transaction validation. Instead, individuals within the Bitcoin network engage in "mining," a competitive process involving the resolution of cryptographic puzzles to create additional units of the currency. The participant who successfully solves the puzzle most swiftly earns the privilege of verifying transactions and appending the latest batch to the blockchain. This victor receives a financial reward in the form of new cryptocurrency, a mechanism known as "proof of work" (PoW), which has been identified as the source of greenhouse gas emissions. In fact, a recent report from UNU (2020–2021) shows that 67% of the electricity consumed for Bitcoin mining was produced from fossil energy sources, with 45% coming specifically from coal. In contrast, renewable energy sources accounted for only 7% of the total electricity used in the mining process. Thus, the adverse environmental effects of cryptocurrencies have long been a concern for policymakers and investors in the clean energy markets. However, limited studies have investigated the impact of cryptocurrencies' environmental attention (ICEA) on its own and associated markets, including the renewable energy markets.

Recent studies show that the consensus algorithms used in most existing cryptocurrencies today significantly increase energy demand for mining and transaction verification activities. This situation has prompted some researchers to propose various solutions. Some focus on limiting the size of cryptocurrencies-related activities by establishing legal frameworks and regulatory restrictions. Others propose developing new consensus algorithms that consume less energy. However, this solution does not entirely solve the problem. Therefore, additional perspectives recommend exploring new energy sources that can serve as an alternative to fossil energy sources for mining operations in the cryptocurrency markets. Both solutions imply that the current transactional system of cryptocurrencies phases in negative spillovers on other markets, including clean energy markets.

Regarding the interrelationship between cryptocurrency dynamics and environmentally sustainable energy indices, previous studies suggest that cryptocurrency and clean energy indices exhibit co-movements when markets are experiencing high levels of global uncertainty. But during the regular times, they remain detached from each other. Thus, both markets can act as a hedge against one another. This argument was confirmed by other studies, where green financial assets were found to offer more diversification

against cryptocurrencies, indicating that green investors stick to their green investments and steer clear of the financial risk associated with cryptocurrencies, especially during economically unstable times. On the other hand, some scholars argue that renewable energy indices have a significant spillover effect on cryptocurrency markets. In contrast, cryptocurrency markets do not explain the volatilities in the renewable energy markets. In the same context, previous studies suggest that green financial assets like green bonds and clean energy index play a vital role in promoting environmental targets, and provide a reasonable risk hedging against the high volatilities in the cryptocurrencies markets, in addition to their contribution to investment portfolios diversification.

Despite valuable contributions to this topic, the relationship between environmental attention surrounding cryptocurrencies and renewable energy markets remains relatively underexplored. Previous studies suggest that while global financial markets are increasingly integrating cryptocurrency markets, the direct spillover effects on renewable energy markets have been relatively modest. Although there is some evidence of renewable energy markets absorbing volatility shocks from cryptocurrency markets, the overall magnitude of this impact appears limited compared to other sectors. Additionally, studies exploring the environmental attention index (ICEA) have shown that ICEA positively correlates with cryptocurrency policy and price uncertainty indices, yet its broader effects on clean energy markets remain unclear. Furthermore, research highlights that investor behaviour in cryptocurrency markets, particularly among 'dirty crypto' investors, may lead to negative environmental outcomes. Therefore, further investigation is needed to fully understand how ICEA influences the interconnected dynamics between cryptocurrencies and renewable energy markets, beyond the limited evidence currently available.

Question 4

Which of the following most precisely captures the structural progression of the author's argument across the passage?

- 1) Technical explanation of blockchain validation – Economic consequences for investors – Empirical testing of spillovers – Policy advocacy for renewables.
- 2) Environmental externalities of mining – Evaluation of corrective strategies – Conditional market interdependence – Identification of an unresolved research gap.
- 3) Historical evolution of cryptocurrencies – Comparative energy efficiencies – Market integration thesis – Empirical refutation of spillovers.
- 4) Regulatory failures in digital finance – Technological redesign proposals – Investor behavior modeling – Evidence of systemic financial contagion.

Question 5

All of the following can be reasonably inferred from the passage EXCEPT:

- 1) Renewable energy markets are largely insulated from cryptocurrency-induced volatility across most conditions.
- 2) Green financial instruments may provide portfolio diversification benefits against cryptocurrency volatility.
- 3) During periods of global uncertainty, cryptocurrency and renewable energy indices may exhibit temporary co-movements.
- 4) Environmental attention indices relating to cryptocurrencies are associated with heightened policy and price uncertainty.

Question 6

The expression "negative spillovers" in the second paragraph most nearly implies:

- 1) Beneficial external efficiencies transmitted across interconnected financial systems.

- 2) Regulatory constraints that reduce speculative investment behavior.
- 3) Adverse cross-market effects arising from cryptocurrency transactional mechanisms.
- 4) Short-term volatility clustering within digital asset price movements.

Question 7

By introducing consensus algorithms in the second paragraph, the author primarily aims to:

- 1) Demonstrate that technological innovation has substantially mitigated cryptocurrency-related environmental damage.
 - 2) Establish that regulatory oversight is the principal determinant of cryptocurrency market volatility.
 - 3) Suggest that alternative validation protocols have already replaced energy-intensive systems.
 - 4) Highlight that the foundational validation mechanisms of cryptocurrencies structurally intensify energy consumption.
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Question 8

The given sentence is missing in the paragraph below. Decide where it best fits among the options 1, 2, 3, or 4 indicated in the paragraph.

Sentence: There's another dimension to this conversation that rarely gets mentioned: the planet itself.

Paragraph: For decades we worried about teenage pregnancy, unstable households and children born into economic precarity. ____1____. Now many young women are choosing to wait until they feel ready — financially, emotionally, relationally. That's not social decline. That's agency. ____2____. The world's population has more than doubled since 1960. ____3____. During that same period, global wildlife populations, according to the World Wildlife Fund and other sources, have fallen by nearly 70 percent. Forests, coral reefs and freshwater systems are under severe strain. ____4____. We are living in what scientists call a sixth mass extinction.

- 1) Option 1
 - 2) Option 2
 - 3) Option 3
 - 4) Option 4
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Directions for Questions 9 to 12: The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

Suppose we design an AI system to model moral decision-making. Like other AI systems – whether predicting stock prices, navigating roads or curating content – it would be programmed to maximise certain predefined objectives. To do so, it must rely on formal, computational logic: either deductive or else probabilistic reasoning. In either case, the AI must adopt a mathematical structure for moral evaluation. But Gödel's incompleteness theorems reveal a fundamental limitation, that any formal system powerful enough to express arithmetic, such as the natural numbers and their operations, cannot be both complete and consistent. If such a system is consistent, there will always be true statements it cannot prove. In particular, as applied to AI, this suggests that any system capable of rich moral reasoning will inevitably have moral blind spots: ethical truths that it cannot derive. .. If the system is inconsistent, then it could prove anything at all, including contradictions, rendering it useless as a guide for ethical decisions.

Gödel's incompleteness theorems apply not only to AI, but to any ethical reasoning framed within a formal system. The key difference is that human reasoners can, at least in principle, revise their assumptions,

adopt new principles, and rethink the framework itself. AI, by contrast, remains bound by the formal structures it is given, or operates within those it can modify only under predefined constraints. In this way, Gödel's theorems place a logical boundary on what AI, if built on formal systems, can ever fully prove or validate about morality from within those systems.

... However, Gödel's incompleteness theorems do reveal a deep limitation of algorithmic reasoning, in particular AI, one that concerns not just computation, but moral reasoning itself. Without his theorems, it was at least conceivable that an AI could formalise all moral truths and, in addition, prove them from a consistent set of axioms. But Gödel's work shows that this is impossible. No AI, no matter how sophisticated, could prove all moral truths it can express. The gap between truth claims and provability sets a fundamental boundary on how far formal moral reasoning can go, even for the most powerful machines.

This raises two distinct problems for ethics. The first is an ancient one. As Plato suggests in the Euthyphro, morality is not just about doing what is right, but understanding why it is right. ..This ideal of rational moral justification has animated much of our ethical thought, but Gödel's theorems suggest that, if moral reasoning is formalised, then there will be moral truths that cannot be proven within those systems. In this way, Gödel did not only undermine Hilbert's vision of proving mathematics consistent; he may also have shaken Plato's hope of fully grounding ethics in reason.

The second problem is more practical. Even a high-performing AI may encounter situations in which it cannot justify or explain its recommendations using only the ethical framework it has been given. The concern is not just that AI might act unethically but also that it could not demonstrate that its actions are ethical. This becomes especially urgent when AI is used to guide or justify decisions made by humans. Even a high-performing AI will encounter a boundary beyond which it cannot justify or explain its decisions using only the resources of its own framework. No matter how advanced it becomes, there will be ethical truths it can express, but never prove.

Question 9

All of the following can be reasonably inferred from the passage EXCEPT:

- 1) If moral reasoning is formalised within a sufficiently expressive system, some ethical truths may remain unprovable despite being meaningfully articulated.
- 2) An inconsistent formal framework would compromise ethical guidance because it could generate incompatible recommendations without logical restraint.
- 3) Human moral agents are entirely exempt from Gödelian limits because they can always step outside any structured system of reasoning.
- 4) Even a highly capable AI may encounter cases where it cannot justify its recommendation using only the principles embedded within its assigned framework.

Question 10

Which one of the following best summarises the passage?

- 1) The passage argues that advances in computational power will eventually enable AI to prove all moral truths, provided its axioms are sufficiently refined.
- 2) The passage contends that Gödel's incompleteness theorems impose structural limits on formal moral reasoning, creating both philosophical and practical challenges for AI systems.
- 3) The passage maintains that moral reasoning cannot meaningfully be expressed in formal systems and therefore excludes AI from ethical deliberation altogether.

- 4) The passage suggests that inconsistency within moral systems may be acceptable if it enhances flexibility in complex decision-making contexts.

Question 11

Choose the one option below that comes closest to being the opposite of the kind of "formal, consistent moral system" described in the passage.

- 1) The tribunal adopted a contextualist method, revising its guiding principles across cases and allowing evolving interpretive judgements to override fixed axioms when circumstances required.
- 2) The panel endorsed a rigorously axiomatic framework, deriving conclusions strictly from a stable set of internally coherent principles and rejecting outcomes that conflicted with those foundations.
- 3) The commission implemented a probabilistic model, calibrating moral recommendations according to weighted predictive outcomes while preserving logical consistency within its evaluative schema.
- 4) The board affirmed a codified rule-based system, ensuring that every recommendation followed deductively from a predefined hierarchy of formally articulated moral postulates.

Question 12

The passage claims that Gödel's theorems create a boundary between truth and provability in formal systems. Which one of the following assumptions must hold for that boundary to constrain AI moral reasoning?

- 1) AI moral evaluation must operate within a formal structure sufficiently expressive to encode arithmetic or its functional equivalent.
- 2) All moral truths must be reducible to quantitative calculations capable of probabilistic verification.
- 3) Human moral judgement functions independently of any structured or rule-governed reasoning process.
- 4) Every ethical dilemma can be exhaustively classified into predefined categories without residual ambiguity.

Directions for Questions 13 to 16: The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

The word 'revolution' enjoys a special place in our political vocabulary. It is associated with events that shaped the modern world – the English Revolution of the mid-17th century, the French Revolution of 1789, the revolutions of 1848, the Russian Revolution of 1917 and the Chinese Revolution beginning in 1927. In each of these, the word refers to a sudden transformation. It signifies a radical change of regime – most commonly involving a shift from monarchy to republic. Two important new works both argue that the word has not always been confined to this single register of meaning.

Dan Edelstein's *The Revolution to Come* takes us from periods of upheaval in ancient Greece through the French and Russian Revolutions, pointing to a dramatic shift in the understanding of revolutionary change that emerged in the 18th century. Originally denoting a destructive breakdown, the word came to stand for abundant promise. From Thucydides to Machiavelli, the state was a means of preserving the common good against the threat of civil implosion. However, by the late 18th century, revolution pledged perfection in the future.

Besides political change, revolution also came to mean economic and social transformation. The 'Industrial Revolution' is probably the most obvious case in point. Many political revolutions brought with them social and economic change. Constitutional revolution in 17th-century England was paired with extensive religious conflict. The Russian Revolution transfigured the structure of society and the management of the economy. The Marxist revolution intended to achieve comprehensive socioeconomic reconstruction.

Both Sassoon and Edelstein emphasise the optimism of revolution and underline the scale of disappointment. Sassoon is the leading chronicler of the history of socialism – a cosmopolitan bourgeois intellectual, polylingual and deeply cultured. Although historically a committed partisan of the Left, he mercilessly exposes the shortcomings of his own tribe. Edelstein, by comparison, is a liberal skeptic, immune to the temptations of the revolutionary Left. Yet notwithstanding their different starting points, both converge on the same viewpoint: the 'age of revolutions' has come to a close.

A central figure in Edelstein's narrative is the Greek author Polybius, whose *Histories* charted the fortunes of the Roman Republic. Our term 'revolution' derives from his phrase for the cycle of constitutional change in which one political system is succeeded by another in a process of perpetual metamorphosis: monarchy turns into tyranny, tyranny into democracy and so on. With the advent of 1789, however, this conception underwent abrupt alteration. Events in France raised expectations of a 'transfigured future', associating revolution with a golden age to come – a hope propagated by leading Enlightenment philosophes including Voltaire, Turgot and Diderot.

Edelstein argues that the confrontation between revolutionaries and counter-revolutionaries bred the institutionalised violence characteristic of modern revolutions. The idea of 'revolutionary government' was born, theorised further by Marx and Lenin. Now the state was charged with speeding the passage to a better world while sacrificing immediate peace and prosperity. Sassoon concurs: the engine of progress typically veers into a frenzy of destruction. As the anti-revolutionary Mallet du Pan observed, 'like Saturn, the revolution devours its children.'

Question 13

What role does Polybius play in Edelstein's historical account of revolution?

- 1) He represents the earlier view of revolution as a cyclical process of constitutional change.
- 2) He represents the radical view of revolution as a disruptive force of change.
- 3) He represents the contentious view of revolution as a positive transformer.
- 4) He was the father of the modern view of revolution as a process of permanent change.

Question 14

What conclusion can be drawn about the relationship between revolutionary optimism and its outcomes?

- 1) The means of revolution are violent but their end is always peace and stability.
- 2) Revolutionary hopes for progress often culminate in violence and destruction.
- 3) Violence in revolutions is an inevitable path to progress.
- 4) Revolutionaries proclaim progress as their end but are violent in intent.

Question 15

Why did modern revolutions become associated with institutionalised violence, according to Edelstein?

- 1) Because revolutionary governments had no plans about the future.
- 2) Because revolutionary goals seldom went beyond the revolution itself.
- 3) Because revolutionary governments assumed responsibility for forcing rapid progress toward an ideal future.
- 4) Because revolutionary governments were too slow to implement their objectives of rapid progress.

Question 16

What does the reference to Mallet du Pan's remark suggest about revolutionary movements?

- 1) They tend to destroy their own leaders and ideals in the process of pursuing radical change.
- 2) They tend to glorify their leaders at the cost of the ideals of pursuing radical change.
- 3) They are misled and eventually betrayed by demagogues with vested interests.
- 4) Their leaders and ideals are extolled to mythical levels which is counterproductive.

Directions for Questions 17 to 20: The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

The Chilean poet-politician Pablo Neruda was a self-described 'thing-ist'. Neruda was a passionate socialist and an erudite collector of curious objects – carved pipes, grotesque African masks, ships in bottles, whales' teeth. 'In my house I have put together a collection of small and large toys I can't live without,' he said. He wisely understood that 'the man who doesn't play has lost forever the child who lived in him and he will certainly miss him'. For Neruda, children figured as materialistic in the purest and most playful sense, delighting in textures, noises, colours, the taste of a rattle, the subversive shock of a magic trick.

Neruda saw no clash between this celebratory 'thing-ism' and socialism's impulse towards redistribution. He would give his toys away if guests asked, but expected the same generosity in return. His poems celebrated objects both ordinary and unique – he wrote odes to birds, stones, socks, the Pacific ocean, spoons, salmon-bellied eels, which frequently segued into praising the often hidden beauty of working people. 'In my poems,' he wrote, 'I could not shut the door to the street, just as I could not shut the door to love, life, joy, or sadness'.

By contrast, the foot-soldiers of General Pinochet who trampled through Neruda's home on the day of his funeral in September 1973, burning his books and smashing some of his artefacts, were archetypal and literal consumers. Could it be that the problem with our whole neo-liberal experiment, championed early on by Augusto Pinochet, is not that it values material things too much – but that it doesn't truly value them enough?

In recent years, a range of voices from science, philosophy, political activism and the arts have begun to suggest exactly that, coalescing into a movement that can ground us ever more mindfully in the material world. The 'new materialism' challenges us to love our possessions not less but more – to cherish them enough to care about where they came from, who made them, what will happen to them in the future.

For a new materialist, the term 'inanimate object' is similarly inadequate to describe the things that we collect and discard. In *Vibrant Matter* (2010), Bennett writes that if we paid attention to the aliveness of matter, we wouldn't be so careless with our stuff. But the disjointedness of hyper-consumerism conceals the continuing life of objects, built anonymously in distant factories and eventually left to leech chemicals into landfill: 'How, for example, would patterns of consumption change,' she asks, 'if we faced not litter, rubbish, trash, or "the recycling", but an accumulating pile of lively and potentially dangerous matter?'

Another name for this is awareness – a spiritual virtue increasingly cultivated in the West through the growing popularity of Buddhism and meditation. By focusing upon a raisin for 15 minutes, as I was once exhorted to do in pursuit of mindfulness, you can find yourself inside a sensory fractal of awe, tracing its tiny life from seed to sap to vine, to sun-baked plumpness, as if on some benign hallucinogenic trip. It's

certainly never 'just a raisin' again.

Question 17

Which of the following best captures Neruda's understanding of the relationship between material objects and human fulfillment?

- 1) Adults who gather possessions understand the meaning objects hold for them.
- 2) Objects gain meaning when people engage with them in a playful, mindful way.
- 3) Attachment to objects is meaningful but should allow generous exchange.
- 4) Objects matter equally for practical use and emotional comfort.

Question 18

The passage contrasts Pinochet's soldiers with Neruda primarily to suggest that:

- 1) Political authority can sometimes damage cultural and artistic expression.
- 2) Consumer attitudes that ignore meaning can lead to careless destruction.
- 3) Economic ideology often encourages excessive acquisition of material goods.
- 4) Artistic sensibility flourishes better under certain political traditions.

Question 19

The author's discussion of 'vibrant materiality' suggests that:

- 1) Seeing objects as lively matter could reshape habits of consumption.
- 2) Scientific views of matter reinforce older spiritual beliefs about objects.
- 3) Modern physics challenges the idea that objects are truly inanimate.
- 4) Awareness of waste rarely alters patterns of consumer behaviour.

Question 20

All of the following weaken the author's argument EXCEPT:

- 1) Many goods are designed for disposal, encouraging guilt-free replacement.
- 2) Consumers often form quick attachments to newly purchased possessions.
- 3) Goods are sometimes discarded because functional needs have changed.
- 4) Recycling systems reduce the volume of discarded material in landfills.

Question 21

Five jumbled sentences (labelled 1, 2, 3, 4, and 5), related to a topic, are given below. Four of them can be put together to form a coherent paragraph. Identify the odd sentence out and key in the number of that sentence as your answer.

1. ADHD – and autism – are neurodiversities, meaning that the brains of individuals with ADHD and/or autism are "wired" differently from those of people with "typical" brains.
2. In other words, you either have it or you don't. To suggest that everyone is a bit ADHD or a bit autistic is insulting to those of us who actually are ADHD/autistic, and diminishes our lived experience.
3. Yes, self-help tools can be useful.
4. The process of diagnosis is robust and not undertaken lightly.
5. But the affirmation of a diagnosis can also be hugely beneficial.

[Integer Type — Key in the number of the odd sentence]

Question 22

The four sentences (labelled 1, 2, 3, and 4) given below, when properly sequenced, would yield a coherent paragraph. Decide on the proper sequencing of the order of the sentences and key in the sequence of the four numbers as your answer.

1. "Their voices are 'the only way you can know them'", and the prisoner begins to wonder who they are — young or old, stern or indifferent.
2. You respond to disembodied questions in writing, lifting the blindfold only when required, while the unseen interrogators remain positioned behind you.
3. Blindfolded and seated facing a wall during interrogation at Tehran's Evin prison, the detainee is denied even the smallest visual cues of those in authority.
4. Twice imprisoned by Iran's theocratic regime, Jafar Panahi — among the country's most internationally recognised film-makers — recalls the experience with unsettling clarity.

[Integer Type — Key in the correct sequence]

Question 23

The passage given below is followed by four summaries. Choose the option that best captures the essence of the passage.

I have a kind of game I play with grief, imagining the birds I see are the people I've lost. When my identical twin brothers died unexpectedly — one to heart failure 20 years ago, one to suicide more recently — words deserted me in those first days of grief. I found, though, that if I could get out the door with my camera and into a landscape that called to me, I thankfully could still photograph. For me, that landscape is South Dakota, where I moved with my father, mother and younger sister when I was 15 years old and where my parents lived for more than 50 years. My brother Dave is a belted kingfisher (shared quirky fashion sense); his twin, Mike, is a Townsend's solitaire (complicated yet unforgettable song). Seeing either of these species while out birding in South Dakota makes me smile — that same half-smile of my brothers' that often accompanied their gently teasing senses of humor.

- 1) The author copes with the grief of losing twin brothers by photographing birds in meaningful landscapes, symbolically connecting each species to cherished memories of them.
- 2) Reflecting on family loss, the author describes returning to South Dakota to pursue bird photography as a therapeutic way to process emotional trauma.
- 3) The passage recounts how nature photography and birdwatching helped the author overcome the silence and shock that followed unexpected personal bereavements.
- 4) The author remembers deceased siblings through a private ritual of associating bird species with their personalities while revisiting places tied to family history.

Question 24

Five jumbled sentences (labelled 1, 2, 3, 4, and 5), related to a topic, are given below. Four of them can be put together to form a coherent paragraph. Identify the odd sentence out and key in the number of that sentence as your answer.

1. On the Deptford foreshore, a ghoulish figure is sinking into the Thames.
2. As they dip down further, their mutant costume — sewn together from 24 adult nappies — swells with water ... and waste.
3. As artist-in-residence at queer performance and discussion season Rat Park, mennell drenched themselves in a gloopy, lube-like thickening agent to explore pollution and shame, and gathered the audiences' spit in their hand as a meditation on community.
4. mennell's work smears the personal and political across their body and the Thames performance is the finale of a project called (para)site, made in response to revelations of sewage discharge in our waterways and a reaction to the way benefit claimants are labelled as a drain on society.

5. Performance artist zack mennell (who writes their name in lower case) wades to their belly button as a crowd watches on.

[Integer Type — Key in the number of the odd sentence]